



YOUR ULTIMATE GUIDE TO

Selling Seattle

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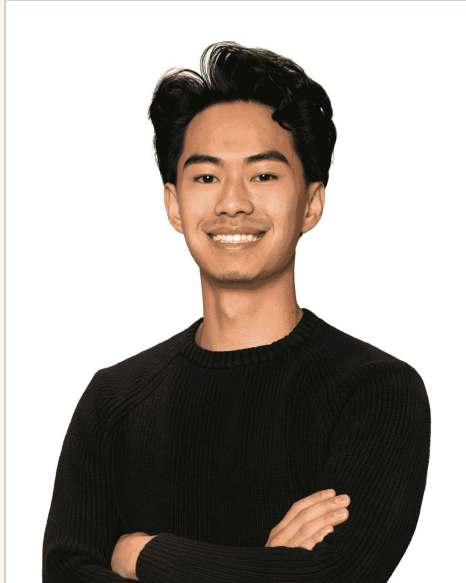
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Fun Fact!

Seattle homes priced correctly at listing get their first offer, on average, within 8 days. Overpriced homes often wait 45 days or more.

A QUICK INTRODUCTION

Get To Know Louis



Louis Lock has helped Seattle families buy and sell across every neighborhood from Ballard to Beacon Hill. He built his practice on a simple idea: a home sale should feel calm, informed, and honest, even when the market is not.

When you work with Louis, you get one point of contact from the first pricing conversation to the final signature. No handoffs, no call centers, and no jargon left unexplained.

Seattle

Born, based, and selling right here

Local

A resident and neighbor, not a franchise

1-on-1

Direct access to Louis at every step

My Promise

You will always know where your sale stands and what happens next. If I don't have an answer yet, I will tell you that too.

Before You List

Selling a home in Seattle moves through seven stages, from pricing strategy to the day you hand over the keys. Some sellers move through all seven in ten weeks. Others take longer, especially if repairs or a slow offer season get in the way. This guide walks you through each stage so you know what is coming and what is expected of you.

TYPICAL PACE

60 to 90 Days

First walkthrough to closing. Off-market sales move faster, often 1 to 3 weeks.

YOUR ROLE

Four Decisions

Price, prep, offer, and closing terms. Everything else, Louis handles.

HOW TO USE THIS

Read, Then Return

Read the process pages once. Then flip back to whichever stage you're in.

Fun Fact!

Homes that are cleaned, depersonalized, and professionally photographed tend to draw more showings in their first week than homes that skip the prep.

The Process

01

Discovery & Pricing Strategy

Louis walks the property, reviews recent sales within a half mile, and sets a price built on data instead of hope. This step usually takes three to five days.



Two Paths From Here

TRADITIONAL LISTING

The path most sellers know: list publicly, host showings, field offers from buyers who need financing. Continues below.

OFF-MARKET CASH SALE

Sourced directly from Louis's network of buyers. No listing, no showings, no financing contingencies. Closes in 1 to 3 weeks.

TRADITIONAL LISTING, CONTINUED

02

Market Preparation

Deep clean, depersonalize, stage the main living spaces, and schedule professional photography. Budget one to two weeks.



03

Repairs & Touch-Ups

Address anything an inspector would flag before a buyer does: leaky faucets, cracked caulk, a sticky door. Small fixes now prevent bigger negotiations later.

The Process, Continued

04

Go To Market

Your home goes live with photos, a floor plan, and a listing description built around what actually sells the property. A launch weekend of showings usually follows.

05

Offers & Negotiation

Offers typically arrive within the first one to two weeks. Louis reviews each one's price, financing terms, and contingencies with you side by side.

06

Under Contract

Inspection, appraisal, and the buyer's lender review all happen in this window, usually 14 to 21 days.

07

Closing Day

Final walkthrough, signing, and the transfer of funds. Keys change hands, typically by early afternoon.



Realtor For Life

Closing day isn't the end of the relationship. Call Louis for a referral, a contractor recommendation, or a market check any time after you've moved. No obligation and no expiration date.

Your Seller Checklist

Before You List

- Order any needed repairs
- Schedule a deep clean and depersonalizing pass
- Gather HOA documents, permits, and warranty records
- Set a moving timeline

Before You Close

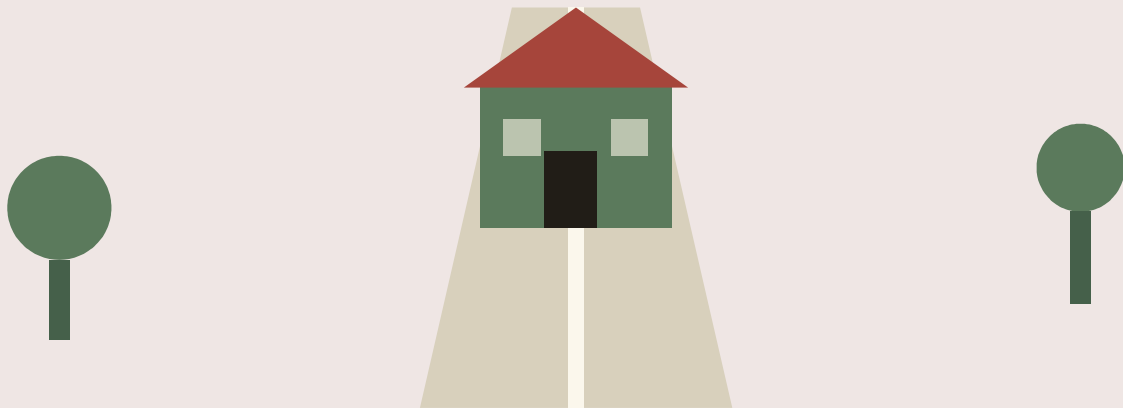
- Confirm your payoff amount with your lender
- Schedule movers 2 to 3 weeks out
- Forward mail and transfer utilities
- Review the closing disclosure line by line

Typical Seller Costs At A Glance

AGENT COMMISSION	CLOSING COSTS	REPAIRS & PREP	MOVING COSTS
5 to 6% of sale price, split between listing and buyer's agents.	1 to 3% of sale price: title, escrow, and excise tax.	\$500 to \$100,000 depending on the home's condition, age, and scope.	\$800 to \$4,000 for a local move, more for long-distance.

Staying On Track

Under contract doesn't mean done. Plenty can still shake a deal loose between accepted offer and closing, and some of it is squarely in your hands. Keep the property, the paperwork, and your commitments steady until the sale records.



Seller Beware: Things To Avoid Under Contract

- ✗ Removing fixtures or appliances you agreed to include
- ✗ Starting renovations or major changes mid-contract
- ✗ Letting your homeowners insurance lapse before closing
- ✗ Missing disclosure or agreed repair deadlines
- ✗ Ignoring the buyer's reasonable inspection requests
- ✗ Making side agreements outside the written contract

Understanding Title & Escrow

Two terms come up over and over near closing. Here is what each one means and why it matters to you as the seller.

TITLE

Proof You Own It

Title is the legal record of ownership. A title company runs a search to confirm the home is yours to sell and that no old liens, unpaid taxes, or claims are attached. In Washington, the seller customarily provides an owner's title insurance policy to the buyer.

ESCROW

The Neutral Middle

Escrow is a neutral third party that holds the money and documents until every condition is met. Nobody gets paid, and no keys change hands, until both sides have done what they agreed to. It protects you and the buyer equally.

What Escrow Handles For You

- Holds the buyer's earnest money deposit
- Coordinates your mortgage payoff
- Prorates property taxes and utilities
- Records the deed with the county
- Disburses your net proceeds
- Collects and files closing documents

Good To Know

Your net proceeds usually land in your account within one to two business days after the deed records, not always the same afternoon you sign.